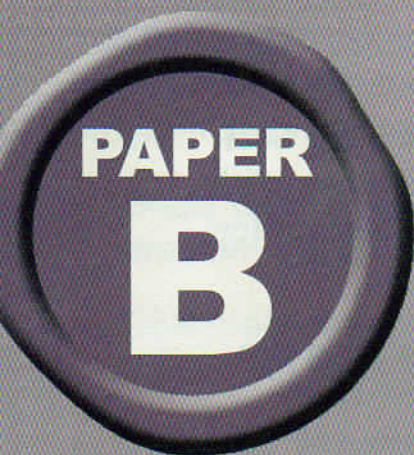




UNSW
THE UNIVERSITY OF NEW SOUTH WALES
SYDNEY • AUSTRALIA

EDUCATIONAL ASSESSMENT
AUSTRALIA



ICAS

INTERNATIONAL COMPETITIONS AND
ASSESSMENTS FOR SCHOOLS

WRITING 2009

ARGUMENT

DO NOT OPEN THIS BOOKLET UNTIL INSTRUCTED.

TIME ALLOWED: 30 MINUTES

5 minutes reading and planning time
20 minutes writing time
5 minutes checking time

STUDENT'S NAME:

Read the instructions on the **ANSWER BOOKLET** and fill in your **NAME, SCHOOL** and **OTHER INFORMATION**.

Use a 2B or B pencil.

Do **NOT** use a pen.

Rub out any mistakes completely.

You are **NOT** allowed to use a dictionary or an electronic translator.

PLEASE SEE BACK COVER FOR A LIST
OF THE YEAR LEVELS THAT SHOULD
SIT THIS PAPER

Argument

Read the following book review:

The Other Side of the Moon is a new picture book which has been beautifully illustrated by author-illustrator Rennie Marsh. With its fanciful pictures and familiar storyline, it has the instant feel of a classic like *Where the Wild Things Are*.

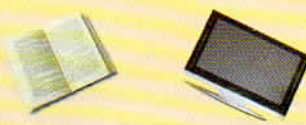
Each night Hannah leans on her window and gazes up at the moon, wondering what is on the side she cannot see. Her imagination is brought to life through brilliantly coloured paintings of fantastic creatures, scary monsters and, surprisingly, a family rather like her own.

Young children will want to have this book read to them over and over again at bedtime, while older readers will delight in the wonderfully detailed illustrations.

A book review gives readers an idea of what the book is about and suggests who might enjoy reading it. It also tells readers whether the book is worth reading and gives reasons why.

Reviewers choose language which suits the work that they are reviewing. This reviewer has used

- words which indicate the type of book e.g. *picture book*, *illustrations*
- words which appeal to people who will want to read the book e.g. *fantastic creatures*, *scary monsters*
- references to similar books e.g. *a classic like Where the Wild Things Are*.



WRITING TASK

You have been asked to write a review for a children's newsletter. You can write a review of either a book **OR** a television program. The book or television program does not have to be real.

- Begin your review by telling readers what type of book or television program it is and who might enjoy it.
- Give readers an idea of what the book or television program is about. You do not have to write the whole story.
- Include a recommendation about the work you are reviewing. Give reasons for your recommendation.
- Use interesting words to describe the book or program and your feelings about it.

HINTS

- Use the planning time to organise your ideas.
- Stay on the topic: **Write a review of a book OR a television program.** Remember that the book or program does not have to be real.
- Write different types of sentences. Make sure your sentences are correct.
- Pay attention to spelling and punctuation.
- Use the time at the end of the task to check and improve your writing.

ACKNOWLEDGMENT

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**THE FOLLOWING YEAR LEVELS
SHOULD SIT THIS PAPER:**

AUSTRALIA: Year 4

NEW ZEALAND: Year 5

SINGAPORE: Primary 3

**PAPER
B**